French workers?”

“They’re easily stolen.”

“Give me names. The thieves will be severely punished.”

“I don’t know who steals them. It happens at night; people go through my things, and in the morning, the vouchers are gone.” She took a breath. “It could be women from another barracks.”

“I can’t say I’m surprised. The Slavs have a natural predilection toward crime. Of course, I can arrange . . .” He thought for a moment. “Rather than going through the administrative burden of requesting more vouchers.” He opened a desk drawer. “Why don’t I give you a small amount of cash every night when you come with the reports?” He pulled out a five-Reichsmark note from his wallet and handed it to her.

She could hardly believe her eyes. Five Reichsmarks every day. She’d earn the equivalent of a second salary in a week. “Thank you.”

“I’ll give instructions that the train tickets for you and Léa should be issued for next month. Autumn in Berlin. Save some of those Reichsmarks so that you two can enjoy yourselves in our esteemed capital with your cousin.” He smirked. “Did I get that right?”

She nodded, noticing a sharpness in his tone, like the blade of a dagger. Had she missed something?

“I think we’ve concluded a satisfactory agreement?”

“Yes.” Maybe she was overthinking. She’d accomplished what she came here to do.

He stood. “Goodnight, Fräulein Cotillard.”

“Goodnight, Herr Reinhardt.”

Rose took her coat and dashed down the stairs. The unease she’d felt on the way up had worn off. She would help Josef to protect the sick and do what she could to keep any name off the list by distracting the Kriminalinspektor with her nightly visits. Léa would be proud, and she would go to Berlin to see André. Tucking the five-Reichsmark note inside her pocket, Rose reached the last tread in no time, her step lighter than before.